

followup

New unbreakable copy-protection scheme

JVC has announced that it will use a CD-ROM copy protection scheme based on collaboration between itself and Japanese company Hudson-soft. The scheme, called Root, records an encryption key when a CD-ROM is created in such a way that an error is generated when any



attempt is made to play back software from copied disks. It will be built into CD-ROMs so that copying to CD-R/RW disks cannot circumvent it. The technology prevents encryption keys being read when copied disks are played back, and JVC hopes to sell mastering units incorporating the copy protection to other manufacturers. The same technique can also be used to prevent copying of DVDs and other media.

snapshot

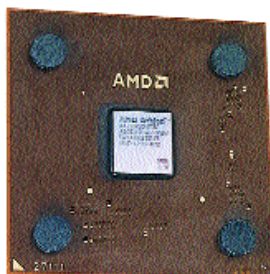
Of the total
1.6 Gbps of
bandwidth avail-
able in india, over
50 per cent is

Source: The Financial Express

Processor wars

AMD is all set to introduce a four-way product, which will provide a choice of x86-based, four to eight-way servers. AMD has previously shown single and dual-processor configurations of its eighth-generation processor family, running both 32-bit and 64-bit operating systems. The AMD Opteron processor is designed to scale from one to eight processors with no external logic required. This can reduce the cost and complexity of building servers and workstations and increase scalability.

Modern micro-chips in use today are based on 32-bit technology and so far, the maximum frequency the developers have reached on



the Pentium 4 is 3.5 GHz.

Intel, in the meanwhile, is cutting prices on its processors. When it introduced its 2.8, 2.66 and 2.6 GHz Pentium 4s, it notified resellers of the price cuts, which apply not only to boxed desktop chips, but also to notebook, server and workstation CPUs. There are also rebates on boxed motherboards. The biggest drop is

on the 2.53 GHz Pentium 4 using a 533 MHz front side bus, which amounts to a staggering 62 per cent of its original price. Intel is also currently working on Banias, Intel's first processor for laptop computers that it has designed from scratch.

Quakecon 2002

People travelled from around the world to the Mesquite Convention Center, Texas, to what is known as the Mecca of Network Gaming Events. Quakecon (August 15-18) attracts the best of the best



in the online gaming world, and they come to take a shot at the \$1,00,000 (approx Rs 50 lakh) that's at stake. id Software's continued commitment to Quakecon is perhaps best thought of not only as a sign of gratitude, but as a real chance to see the progress that fans have made in playing the games. It also gives

their fans the opportunity to interact with the developers of the software and mods, which of course leads to some very interesting developments.

A variety of sponsors support LAN gaming and have a chance to reach some of the consumers who are the most difficult to nail down. For four days, these sponsors take the time to talk to the gamers and introduce them to their products. The importance of the gamer market is often overlooked, with many people believing the notion that gamers are not professionals. In reality though, they have regular day jobs and many of them are involved in making buying decisions.

heroes

Gaming Icons

Little Mario has made \$7 billion in revenues, Nintendo said, as it announced the latest incarnation of *Super Mario Sunshine* for the Game Cube. Harrison Ford's films have earned only \$5.6 billion worldwide. Nintendo claims Mario to be the 'leading man' of the entertainment industry!

Print media

Ziff Davis Media (publisher of *PC Magazine* and other technology magazines), had filed for Chapter 11, having been one of the hardest-hit by the advertising slump in the industry. It has now announced that 95.1 per cent of its bondholders had approved its financial restructuring, enabling them to avoid filing for bankruptcy.

zeroes

Jaguar, OS X 10.2

Apple's new OS costs \$129 (approx Rs 6,450), and there is no upgrade-pricing plan. If you've bought a new Mac or the earlier OS X before July 17, you pay a \$20 (approx Rs 1,000) 'fulfilment' fee, otherwise you pay the full price.

Windows

Dell Computer is making Windows optional for some of its business desktops. Dell will introduce the n-Series corporate desktop and workstations that ship without Windows or any other operating system pre-installed. These computers will include a copy of a free, uninstalled operating system, FreeDOS. This move is in direct response to a rising demand for PCs without OSes.